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Social structure and acculturation among the Kanuri of northern Nigeria

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A month after Salla Laya is the festival of Tsuru Mbulo, also called Salla Laya Ngaw[unknown]rinz --the tail of Salla Laya (Ar. Ashura). It took place on the two days of August 5th and 6th. During Tsuru Mbulo pious individuals fast for two days. Unlike Ramadan, this is not an obligatory fast, and younger men tend not to fast while older men keep the fast of Tsuru Mbulo. All, however, participate in the feasting after sunset of the  - 195 - second day. This is the time for paying the zakat, the almstax. Rich men give away clothes and money as sadaka at this time so that they will have good luck. Poor people give away kola nuts and perfume. This is also the time when members of the various jili give small gifts to members of linked jili with whom they have joking relationships (n[unknown]ngima). As the sun sets on the second day all women bang on their water storage pots to drive away the jinn (spirit) who brings sickness. On the second night everyone also bathes. People, women in particular, then go to the houses of Malams where the Malam reads a section of the Koran which is then repeated by those present. The Malam then assigns counting of prayer beads (tajimi) for each person. Later in the night dancing is held in a central area, and many guns are discharged. Little boys mill about knocking sparks off smouldering pieces of wood onto other little boys.

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